NHMEC Wellness Herbalist Diploma

Module 1: Identity of the Wellness Herbalist

Professional Registration Diploma

Estimated Completion Time: 20–25 Hours

Module Overview

Welcome to the Wellness Herbalist Diploma.

You have successfully completed the prerequisite studies in Kitchen PENothecary™, Family Herbalism, Community Herbalism, and Holistic Anatomy & Physiology. This diploma is the integration of those foundational disciplines into a comprehensive model of wellness education.

The Wellness Herbalist is more than someone who understands herbs. A Wellness Herbalist is an educator, steward, mentor, observer, and servant who seeks to encourage wellness through biblical principles, natural wellness education, nutrition, seasonal living, and individualized wellness support.

Throughout this diploma you will learn to integrate herbal knowledge with lifestyle education, professional ethics, community outreach, family wellness, and the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ framework.

This diploma prepares graduates for eligibility to apply for registration through the Natural Health Ministries Education Center (NHMEC) Professional Registry.

Learning Objectives

Upon completion of this module, students will be able to:

- Explain the role of the Wellness Herbalist.
- Describe the biblical foundation of herbal stewardship.
- Differentiate between education and medical practice.
- Explain the NHMEC philosophy of wellness.
- Identify the responsibilities of a registered Wellness Herbalist.
- Develop a personal philosophy of wellness ministry.
- Understand professional ethics and scope of practice.

Required Reading

Primary Text

The Wellness Herbalist: A Guide to Family, Community, Kitchen, and Seasonal Wellness

Read:

- Introduction
- Chapter 1 – The Calling of a Wellness Herbalist

Companion Reading

Review the Introduction of the Wellness Herbalist Companion Manual.

Watch

- Welcome Video
- Wellness Herbalist Protocol Presentation
- Introduction Video

Introduction

The word *wellness* describes an intentional process of pursuing balance in every area of life.

Biblically, mankind was created as an integrated being consisting of body, soul, and spirit. Wellness is not merely the absence of illness but the stewardship of God's creation through proper nourishment, rest, movement, relationships, and faith.

The Wellness Herbalist serves as an educator who helps individuals understand these principles through herbs, nutrition, lifestyle education, seasonal living, and biblical encouragement.

What Is a Wellness Herbalist?

A Wellness Herbalist studies the relationship between people, plants, nutrition, environment, and lifestyle.

The Wellness Herbalist recognizes herbs as part of God's created provision while understanding that true healing ultimately comes from God.

The Wellness Herbalist does not replace physicians or licensed healthcare professionals. Instead, they provide educational guidance that empowers individuals to make informed wellness decisions within their healthcare team.

A Wellness Herbalist encourages:

- Healthy nutrition
- Kitchen herbalism
- Seasonal wellness
- Family wellness
- Community education
- Lifestyle improvement
- Biblical encouragement
- Personal responsibility
- Stewardship of creation

The Biblical Foundation

Scripture repeatedly teaches that God created plants for the benefit of mankind.

Key Scriptures

Psalm 104:14 (KJV)

> "He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and herb for the service of man..."

Genesis 1:29 (KJV)

> "Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed..."

Ezekiel 47:12 (KJV)

> "...and the leaf thereof for medicine."

These passages remind us that herbs are gifts from the Creator and are to be studied and used with wisdom, humility, and gratitude.

The Mission of the Wellness Herbalist

The NHMEC Wellness Herbalist seeks to:

- Educate rather than diagnose.

- Encourage rather than prescribe.
- Support rather than replace medical care.
- Empower families.
- Strengthen communities.
- Honor God through faithful stewardship.

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ serves as the philosophical framework of this diploma.

Perspective

Spiritual health

Faith

Purpose

Biblical worldview

Essence

Mental and emotional wellness

Stress

Relationships

Habits

Character

Nutrition

Physical wellness

Food

Herbs

Movement

Rest

Hydration

Together these three dimensions provide a comprehensive model for wellness education.

Professional Characteristics

A Wellness Herbalist demonstrates:

- Integrity
- Compassion
- Humility
- Professionalism
- Lifelong learning
- Biblical stewardship
- Respect for client autonomy
- Commitment to evidence-informed wellness education

Scope of Practice

The Wellness Herbalist DOES:

- Teach herbal education.
- Explain traditional herbal uses.
- Discuss nutrition.
- Encourage healthy lifestyle habits.
- Develop educational wellness plans.
- Teach herbal preparation techniques.
- Support community wellness initiatives.

The Wellness Herbalist DOES NOT:

- Diagnose disease.
- Prescribe medications.
- Discontinue prescribed treatments.
- Claim to cure disease.
- Replace licensed healthcare professionals.

Professional Ethics

Registered Wellness Herbalists agree to:

- Practice honestly.
- Respect confidentiality.
- Use educational language.
- Remain within scope of practice.
- Continue professional education.
- Serve without discrimination.
- Honor biblical principles.
- Represent herbal wellness responsibly.

Reflection

Take time to consider why you chose to become a Wellness Herbalist.

Reflect upon:

- Who has influenced your wellness journey?
- How has God used herbs in your own life?
- What populations do you feel called to serve?
- What gifts has God given you to teach others?

Record your reflections in your Wellness Journal.

Module Assignment

Assignment 1

My Wellness Herbalist Philosophy

Write a 2–3 page paper describing:

- Why you chose herbal wellness.
- Your philosophy of wellness.
- Your biblical worldview of health.
- How you plan to serve your family or community.
- Your professional goals after graduation.

Discussion Questions

1. What distinguishes a Wellness Herbalist from a traditional herbalist?
2. Why is professional ethics important?
3. Why should herbalists remain within their educational scope?
4. How does biblical stewardship influence wellness?
5. Which component of the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ do you believe is most often neglected today?

Vocabulary

Define the following terms:

- Wellness
- Stewardship
- Herbalist
- Holistic
- Perspective
- Essence
- Nutrition
- Scope of Practice
- Ethics
- Wellness Education

Module Quiz

20 Multiple Choice Questions

Topics include:

- Biblical foundation
- Wellness philosophy
- Holistic P.E.N. Way™
- Professional ethics
- Scope of practice
- Wellness Herbalist responsibilities

Passing Score: **80%**

Students who do not achieve a passing score may review the module and retake the assessment.

Preparing for Module 2

In the next module, students will begin developing professional wellness frameworks using the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ and learn how to integrate body, mind, and spirit into individualized wellness education plans.